

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12383116
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
Inventor(s)	Wade; Jack

System and method for enhanced data analysis with video enabled software tools for medical environments

Abstract

Medical software tools platform utilizes a surgical display to provide access to specific medical software tools, such as medically-oriented applications or tools, that can assist those in the operating room, such as a surgeon or surgical team, with a surgery. In particular, an optical sensor located within an endoscopic camera may register subtle differences in color characteristics reflected from a tissue surface and in turn transmit the information to a medical image processing system. Moreover, the new tools are intended to help surgeons better determine the boundaries between healthy and diseased regions during surgical procedures. Various tools are intended to be used in procedures where indocyanine green (ICG) fluorescent dye is used. Intraoperative fluorescence imaging is commonly used during minimally invasive procedures to enable surgeons to visualize tissue perfusion and anatomical structures. The term perfusion refers to the passage of blood and tissue fluid through the capillary bed. Intraoperative fluorescence imaging can also be used to improve visualization of vessels and structures, which, in turn, may reduce the risk of complications during minimally invasive surgeries.

Inventors:	Wade; Jack (La Jolla, CA)
Applicant:	Wade; Jack (La Jolla, CA)
Family ID:	79166433
Appl. No.:	18/235352
Filed:	August 18, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240122448 A1	Apr. 18, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17338599 20210603 US 11744441 child-doc US 18235352
continuation parent-doc US 16677584 20191107 US 11051891 20210706 child-doc US 17338599
continuation parent-doc US 15958944 20180420 US 10507065 20191217 child-doc US 16677584
continuation parent-doc US 14107329 20131216 US 9526586 20161227 child-doc US 15377817
continuation parent-doc US 13430489 20120326 ABANDONED child-doc US 15170575
continuation-in-part parent-doc US 15789948 20171020 ABANDONED child-doc US 15958944
continuation-in-part parent-doc US 15652031 20170717 US 10433917 20191008 child-doc US 15789948
continuation-in-part parent-doc US 15456458 20170310 US 10758314 20200901 child-doc US 15652031
continuation-in-part parent-doc US 15377817 20161213 ABANDONED child-doc US 15456458
continuation-in-part parent-doc US 15170575 20160601 US 10142641 20181127 child-doc US 16677584
continuation-in-part parent-doc US 12776048 20100507 US 8266333 20120911 child-doc US 13430489
us-provisional-application US 61865037 20130812
us-provisional-application US 61234577 20090817
us-provisional-application US 61182624 20090529

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **A61B1/00** (20060101); **A61B1/04** (20060101); **A61B1/313** (20060101); **A61B34/00** (20160101); **A61B90/00** (20160101); **G16H10/60** (20180101); **G16H20/17** (20180101); **G16H20/40** (20180101); **G16H30/40** (20180101); **G16H40/63** (20180101); **G16H50/70** (20180101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **A61B1/0005** (20130101); **A61B1/000095** (20220201); **A61B1/043** (20130101); **A61B34/25** (20160201); **G16H10/60** (20180101); **G16H20/17** (20180101); **G16H20/40** (20180101); **G16H30/40** (20180101); **G16H40/63** (20180101); **G16H50/70** (20180101); **A61B1/3132** (20130101); **A61B2034/256** (20160201); **A61B90/361** (20160201); **G06T2200/24** (20130101); **G06T2207/30004** (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
6271752	12/2000	Vaios	348/E7.086	H04N 7/141
6285902	12/2000	Kienzle, III	378/205	A61B 17/1721
7039723	12/2005	Hu	709/248	G16H 30/20
8295649	12/2011	Berini	382/304	G06V 10/94
2003/0051021	12/2002	Hirschfeld	709/223	H04L 67/1027
2003/0104806	12/2002	Ruef	348/E7.079	H04M 3/42

2003/0159141	12/2002	Zacharias	348/E5.093	H04N 5/445
2008/0071144	12/2007	Fein	600/178	A61B 1/07
2012/0330103	12/2011	Tenger	600/188	A61M 16/0429
2014/0171759	12/2013	White	600/306	A61B 5/6835
2015/0282749	12/2014	Zand	600/301	A61B 1/0676
2016/0166336	12/2015	Razzaque	606/130	A61B 90/37
2019/0133711	12/2018	Wade	N/A	G16H 30/40

Primary Examiner: Bitar; Nancy

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Olivo IP Law Group, P.C.

Background/Summary

PRIORITY CLAIM (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/338,599, filed Jun. 3, 2021, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/677,584, filed Nov. 7, 2019, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/958,944, filed Apr. 20, 2018, and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,507,065 on Dec. 17, 2019, which is a continuation in part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/789,948, filed Oct. 20, 2017, which is a continuation in part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/652,031, filed Jul. 17, 2017, issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,433,917, on Oct. 8, 2019, which is a continuation in part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/456,458, filed Mar. 10, 2017, which is a continuation in part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/377,817, filed Dec. 13, 2016, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/107,329, filed Dec. 16, 2013, and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 9,526,586 on Dec. 27, 2016, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 61/865,037, filed Aug. 12, 2013. This application also claims the benefit of and is a continuation in part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/170,575, filed Jun. 1, 2016, issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,142,641, on Nov. 27, 2018, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 13/430,489, filed Mar. 26, 2012, which is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 12/776,048, filed May 7, 2010, and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 8,266,333, on Sep. 11, 2012, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Applications Ser. No. 61/182,624, filed May 29, 2009, and 61/234,577, filed Aug. 17, 2009. Each of the foregoing applications is hereby incorporated by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The technology disclosed herein relates to medical software tools and, in particular, some embodiments relate to systems and methods for a software tools platform in a medical environment, such as a surgical environment, incorporating enhanced data analysis.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Disclosed herein is an updated medical software tool platform, aka surgeon's dashboard, comprised of a new set of desktop tools (aka widgets) developed to help medical professionals identify subtle changes in tissue. Various tools are intended to be used in procedures where indocyanine green (ICG) is used. ICG is a fluorescent dye and a marker in the assessment of the perfusion of tissues and organs. The term perfusion refers to the passage of blood and tissue fluid through the capillary bed. Moreover, the new tools are intended to help surgeons better determine the boundaries between healthy and diseased regions during surgical procedures. Intraoperative fluorescence imaging is commonly used during multiple minimally invasive procedures to enable surgeons to visualize tissue perfusion and anatomical structures. The fluorescent imaging agent binds to protein in blood and is metabolized and excreted by the liver thereby providing laparoscopic visualization of the hepatic artery and bile ducts. These dyes enable a precise visual

assessment of blood flow in vessels, as well as the quality of tissue perfusion in, for example, colorectal, esophageal and bariatric surgeries. Intraoperative fluorescence imaging can also be used to improve visualization of vessels and structures, which, in turn, may reduce the risk of complications during minimally invasive surgeries.

(3) Various desktop tools are designed to be used in conjunction with ICG to enhance a surgeon's ability to visualize and analyze tissue perfusion and structural anatomy intraoperatively and in real-time. In certain situations, the tools can be used to help the surgeon visualize and objectively analyze different levels of blood flow in tissue. Moreover, various desktop tools may assist surgeons in making critical decisions in the operating room, which can potentially reduce rates of postoperative complications and decrease healthcare costs.

(4) The new medical software tools include 1) ICG Visualization, 2) Instant Replay, 3) Height Mapping, 4) Grid Tool, 5) Perfusion Visualization and Quantification, 6) Color Collaboration. Each of the individual tools are depicted in the figures below and described in the narrative that follows.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) Various embodiments of the disclosed technology provide a medical software tools platform that utilizes a surgical display to provide access to medical software tools, such as medically-oriented applications or widgets, that can assist those in the operating room, such as a surgeon and their surgical team, with a surgery. For various embodiments, the medical software tools platform and its associated medical software tools are presented on a surgical display (e.g., being utilized in an operating room) over an image stream provided by a surgical camera (e.g., in use in the operating room) or other medical device that generates image streams. An image stream can include video or a series of static images (e.g., medical ultrasound device). Various medical software tools can provide features and functions that can facilitate integration of equipment in an operating room or add medical context awareness to anatomic structures presented in the image stream from the surgical camera.

(6) Medical video display panels and multiscreen displays are commonly employed in such contexts as hospital operating theaters or any facility where surgical operations are carried out in a sterile environment. They are used to display visual information from data streams such as surgical imagery from an endoscope, patient vital signs, patient medical records, clinical imaging data (patient CT scans, MRIs, etc.), outputs from other operating room equipment, and operating room environmental status. Surgical displays and multiscreen video displays provide a surgeon and their surgical team with visual information that can be automatically updated, or can be used to enable collaboration among viewers. Where a surgical display or multiscreen video display is used for group collaboration, there is generally a requirement that the group has the ability to update and reconfigure the visual information displayed, which is usually facilitated through a video switch. Traditional video switches are controlled through a switch box, a keyboard, or a local connection (via an RS-232 port or Ethernet port) and have only a single point for control access. In some contexts, visual data streams to a single large panel video display or a multiscreen display configuration are provided by two or more computer systems, each being controlled by a computer operator (i.e., user) using such input/output (IO) devices as keyboards, mice, and as video monitor.

(7) One of ordinary skill in the art would understand that, depending on the embodiment, either the image stream input interface, the image stream output interface, or both may utilize unidirectional communication or bidirectional communication with input devices and output devices. For example, a system may be configured to receive control information from a controller interface device via an image stream output interface, or to send control information to an image source via an image stream input interface. In another example, the control information is received by the system through the Display Data Channel (DDC). Depending on the embodiment, the system may be configured to send control information to a device external to the system, through the image stream input interface.

(8) In some embodiments, the switching matrix may selectively map an image stream input

interface or a processed image stream in real-time. In further embodiments, the switching matrix may selectively map the image stream input interface to more than one image processing module or to more than one image stream output interface simultaneously. Additionally, in some embodiments, the switching matrix may selectively map the processed image stream to more than one image processing module or to more than one image stream output interface simultaneously. In other embodiments, the switching matrix may selectively map an image stream input interface or the processed image stream based on a criterion. For example, the switching matrix may selectively map an image stream input interface or a processed image stream based on its source or content. In another example, the switching matrix may selectively map a processed image stream based on the results of a preceding image processing module. Depending on the embodiment, the image processing module may have the capability of processing a plurality of image streams in parallel. The image stream interface for some embodiments may be configured to receive the image stream from an image stream capture device, an image stream playback device, a computer system, a sensor device or a medical device (e.g., endoscope). The image stream output interface for some embodiments may be configured to output to a display (e.g., liquid crystal display monitor), a computer system, or recording device (e.g., digital video recorder). Further, in some embodiments, the system may be configured to output an image stream through a virtual display.

(9) In numerous embodiments, the system further comprises a data input interface, wherein the switching matrix is further in communication with the data input interface such that the switching matrix can further selectively map the data input interface to the image stream output interface or to the first image processing module. For some such embodiments, the image stream input interface may comprise the data input interface.

(10) For some embodiments, dynamic selection with respect to inputs means that one or more inputs can be selected or unselected in real time for routing to one or more image processing elements. For additional embodiments, dynamic and iterative selection with respect to processing elements means that a selected image stream can be routed to one or more image processing elements simultaneously and in real time. The routing may be based upon criteria relating to the image stream's source, the image stream's content, or on the processing results of a preceding image processing element. The output of an image processing element may be directed back to the system or method for routing to a subsequent image processing element, or to one or more image outputs that supply an image stream to an output device (e.g., display, image recorder, or other image processor, or transmission device).

(11) An exemplary system for switching control between a plurality of computer systems, comprising a plurality of image stream input interfaces, wherein a first image stream input interface of the plurality of image stream input interfaces is configured to couple with a first computer system of the plurality of computer systems, and wherein a second image stream input interface of the plurality of image stream input interfaces is configured to couple with a second computer system of the plurality of computer systems. The system may further comprise a plurality of computer input device interfaces (e.g., Universal Serial Bus [USB], PS/2, AT connector, Bluetooth, Infrared [IF], or FireWire), wherein a first computer input device interface of the general plurality of computer input device interfaces is configured to couple with the first computer system, and wherein a second computer input device interface of the plurality of general computer input device interfaces is configured to couple with the second computer system.

(12) The system may additionally comprise: an ICG visualization tool that enables the visualization of perfusion of the ICG agent to help identify healthy tissue; an Instant Replay tool that enables a surgeon to replay a portion of the surgical video and to slow down the visual presentation of the absorption process to better characterize the differences in neighboring tissue; a Height Mapping tool that allows mapping of green intensity to reveal greater detail in the presence of ICG; a Grid Tool that overlays a dynamically adjustable grid over a selected area of the surgical video. The number of grid lines along the x and y axes can be increased or decreased by user on the fly; a

Perfusion Visualization and Quantification tool that brings up a panel that quantifies the degree and rate of selected tissue to absorb and dissipate contrast fluid (ICG) injected into a patient's blood stream; and a Color Collaboration tool that allows the surgeon to personalize gamma adjustments in real time. The colors are adjusted and displayed to a standard unique to each individual user. (13) Other embodiments provide for a computer readable storage medium having instructions embedded thereon to cause a processor to perform operations similar to those described above with respect to the various systems and methods in accordance with the present invention. Other features and aspects of the disclosed technology will become apparent from the following detailed description, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, which illustrate, by way of example, the features in accordance with embodiments of the disclosed technology. The summary is not intended to limit the scope of any inventions described herein, which are defined solely by the claims attached hereto.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an example of the overall processing system that may be used in implementing various features of embodiments of the disclosed technology.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating an example of the image processing system that may be used in implementing various features of embodiments of the disclosed technology.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating an example medical software tools platform in accordance with some embodiments of the technology described herein.
- (4) FIG. 4. ICG Visualization, a tool that enables the visualization of perfusion of the ICG agent to help identify healthy tissue.
- (5) FIG. 5. Instant Replay, a tool that enables a surgeon to replay a portion of the surgical video and to slow down the visual presentation of the absorption process to better characterize the differences in neighboring tissue.
- (6) FIG. 6. Height Mapping, a tool that allows mapping of green intensity to reveal greater detail in the presence of ICG.
- (7) FIG. 7. Grid Tool, a tool that overlays a dynamically adjustable grid over a selected area of the surgical video. The number of grid lines along the x and y axes can be increased or decreased by user on the fly.
- (8) FIG. 8. Perfusion Visualization and Quantification, a tool that brings up a panel that quantifies the degree and rate of selected tissue to absorb and dissipate contrast fluid (ICG) injected into a patient's blood stream.
- (9) FIG. 9. Color Collaboration, a tool that allow the surgeon to personalized gamma adjustments in real time. The colors are adjusted and displayed to a standard unique to each individual user.
- (10) FIG. 9.1 is an example of different types of color processing for the Color Collaboration tool.
- (11) FIG. 10. is a block diagram illustrating the ICG Visualization module within the medical software tools platform.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENT

(12) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an example of the overall processing system that may be used in implementing various features of embodiments of the disclosed technology. In accordance with the preferred embodiment of the present invention, the processing system **100** consists of processor elements such as: a central processing unit (CPU) **102**; a graphics processing unit (GPU) **104**; and a field programmable gate array (FPGA) **106**. The processing system **100** may be used to retrieve and process raw data derived from a surgical camera **110** or a data storage device, such as a medical archive **108**. The surgical camera **110** or medical archive **108** transmits a data stream to the processing system **100**, whereby that data is processed by the CPU **102**. The FPGA **106**, connected

to the CPU **102** and the GPU **104**, simultaneously processes the received data by using a series of programmed system algorithms **118**, thus functioning as an image clarifier within the processing system **100**. The GPU **104** communicates with the user interface **112** to display the received data from the medical archive **108**. The GPU **104** enables the user interface to then communicate the data to connected input devices **114** and output devices **116**. The user interface **112** can communicate to multiple input **114** and output devices **116** simultaneously. An input device **114** can include, for example, a keyboard, touchscreen or voice activated device. An output device **116** can include, for example, a video display, a digital video recorder (DVR) or universal serial bus (USB). (13) FIG. **2** is a block diagram illustrating an example of the image processing system that may be used in implementing various features of embodiments of the disclosed technology. In accordance with the preferred embodiment of the present invention, the image processing system **200** consists of three components that process image data received from a sensor **202** in order to send that data to a display or video router **210**. The three components of the image processing system **200** are: camera head video pre-processing **204**; real time video enhancement **206**; and the video display transport **208** function. Image data is collected by a sensor imaging device **202**, and is then transmitted to the camera head video pre-processing component **204** within the image processing system **200**. This data may be, for example, a raw video image that is pre-processed using various image processing algorithms. Image pre-processing may also include software modules for image registration and segmentation to optimize the video data and communicate via the system bus **212** with the internal system processors **214**: the CPU; GPU; and FPGA.

(14) The pre-processed image data is transmitted to the real time video enhancement **206** component, whereby the image data is enhanced to improve clarity or highlight certain details. Once the image data resolution has been enhanced, the video display transport **208** component completes image post-processing, formatting from the initial sensor resolution to the eventual display resolution, for example, enhancing the video data to 1080p HD or 4K display resolution or using software modules such as video cross conversion, scaling and adding graphic overlays. The processed image data is then transmitted from the image processing system **200** to the display or video router **210**. The video display transport also saves the processed image data to the processing system memory **216** that can consist of internal and external memory storage.

(15) FIG. **3** is a block diagram illustrating an example medical software tools platform system in accordance with some embodiments of the technology described herein. The medical software tools platform provides access to medically-oriented applications (apps) or tools that can assist members of the surgical team during an operation. For example, many surgeries utilize ICG to enable surgeons to visualize tissue perfusion and anatomical structures, however, the camera sensor captures much more color detail that the human eye can discern. Therefore, the use of an ICG visualization tool can provide a more accurate and objective measure of the rate of perfusion. An instant replay tool enables the users to replay a portion of the surgical video in slow motion in order to more closely observe the process of perfusion. A height mapping tool provides a simulated 3D visualization that enables the user to quickly and accurately identify areas of highest absorption of the ICG fluorescent dye. A grid tool brings up an overlay that draws grid lines to provide an x,y location reference. This enables a surgeon to precisely mark the location of an anomaly or area of interest for future reference. A perfusion visualization and quantification tool precisely measure the rates of rise and decay of the of fluoresced pixel intensity. This is intended to assist a surgeon in identifying the borders between healthy and diseased tissue. A color calibration tool allows users to configure a color preference so that colors are adjusted and displayed to a standard unique to each individual. This enables color blind surgeons to better visualize information on the surgical display and perceive subtle changes in color.

(16) In accordance with the preferred embodiment of the present invention, the medical software tools platform system **300** includes: an image stream interface module **302**; a user interface overlay module **304**; medical software tools **310**; a medical device interface module **306**; and an image

stream processing system interface module **308**. The medical software tools platform system **300** may be integrated, in whole or in part, into a video display or an image stream processing system utilized in an operating room. The image stream interface module **302** may receive an image stream acquired by a surgical camera or the like. Depending on the embodiment, the image stream may be received directly from the surgical camera, or may be provided by way of one or more components, such as an image stream processing system. The image stream received from the image stream interface module **302** may vary in resolution, frame rate, format, and protocol according to the surgical camera or the image stream processing system providing the image stream.

(17) The user interface overlay module **304** may provide a user interface to the medical software tools platform system **300**, which may include one or more graphical user interface (GUI) elements presented over the image stream received through the image stream interface module **302**. For some embodiments, the user interface comprises a bottom toolbar configured to be presented over the image stream, and configured to provide access to various medical software tools **310** available through the medical software tools platform system **300**.

(18) The medical software tools platform system **300** may include one or more medical software tools, such as medically-oriented applications or widgets, which can be utilized with respect to the image stream being received through the image stream interface module **302**. The medical software tools **310** include but are not limited to: a ICG Visualization module **312**; an instant replay module **314**; a height mapping module **316**; a grid tool module **318**; an perfusion visualization and quantification module **320**; a color calibration module **322**.

(19) The medical device interface module **306** may facilitate communication between the medical software tools platform system **300**, one or more of the medical software tools **310**, and one or more various medical devices utilized in an operating room. The image stream processing system interface module **308** may facilitate communication between the medical software tools platform system **300** and an image stream processing system utilized to process an image stream acquired by a surgical camera or the like. Through the communication, the image stream processing system interface module **308** may transmit control data to an image stream processing system, or receive an image stream from a surgical camera as processed by the image stream processing system. The image stream processing system interface module **308** may include various data interfaces, including wired or wireless network interfaces and serial communication interfaces.

(20) ICG Visualization (FIG. **4**) tool enables the visualization of perfusion of the ICG agent to help identify healthy tissue. The ICG Visualization tool can be used in conjunction with other tools to enable the following capabilities: 1. Slow Motion—replaying the video in slow motion 2. Intensity—quantifying the degree of ICG absorption for defined areas of interest 3. Speed—measuring the time to full absorption for defined areas of interest 4. ICG Map—simulated 3D views of ICG absorption using intensity or speed of ICG data.

(21) In a preferred embodiment the ICG Visualization tool can be used in conjunction with the Slow Motion Replay tool **402** and the Height Mapping tool **404**, which can be integrated into the ICG Visualization user interface. In this implementation, a surgeon might use the ICG Visualization in conjunction with the Slow Motion Replay tool and the Height Mapping tools in a four step process as follows.

(22) In a first step, a user, such as the surgeon or an assistant, uses the mouse to sweep an area of interest. The selected image segment is scaled and centered in the yellow working box as show in the upper left corner **408**.

(23) As ICG is administered, the computer measures time to reach full luminance. The example in FIG. **4** shows this time to be 12 seconds **410**.

(24) Video frames are cached in memory a full frame rate. Slow Motion replays are available at selected speeds and use motion-compensated frame interpolation for a smooth playback. An elevator bar on the right side is used to control image zoom.

(25) In a second step, an operator uses the mouse to create a box around one or more regions of

interest, as shown in FIG. 4 on the right where three yellow boxes are selected **406**.

(26) The intensity and the time to reach full intensity for each region is graphed using the ICG channel to provide a quantitative comparison **410**.

(27) Selected regions are described by outline boxes (dashed yellow areas in the example **406**). Unchecking the form box labeled, “Show Regions” hides the outlines **414**. Region outlines can be moved and resized with the graphs updated in real time.

(28) In a third step, the system quantifies perfusion based on intensity (absorption) and speed **404**.

(29) In a fourth step, the user has the option to invoke slow motion instant replays at selectable speed so that the details of the process of perfusion can be reviewed and studied **402**.

(30) The user also has the option to invoke Height Map tool which shows ICG data in simulated 3D to demonstrate areas of highest perfusion. Both intensity and speed can be mapped and the image can be rotated **404**.

(31) Instant Replay (FIG. 5) tool enables a surgeon to replay a portion of the surgical video. An example above described how Instant Replay can be used to review the speed of ICG contrast agent perfusion to provide the surgeon an opportunity to slow down the visual presentation of the absorption process to better characterize the differences in neighboring tissue. FIG. 5 shows how Instant Replay works. Video from the endoscope is recorded and stored in a special purpose computer that implements various image processing algorithms **500**. The last n seconds of video frames are stored on a circular video frame buffer within the computer **502**. Instant Replay uses video frames from the computer circular memory buffer, playing frames at selected frame rates. The user sets the recall time period and speed from slow motion to speed forward **504**. The user can select algorithms to apply to the video as it is being displayed **506**. The user can also select levels of contrast and brightness for the replay **508**.

(32) The Height Map tool is shown in FIG. 6. To use the tool, the user first sweeps an area of interest with the mouse. The selected area is enlarged and rendered as a “Picture-In-Picture” insert **600**. The insert simulates a 3D view by mapping the area's pixels onto an elevation grid using the pixel intensities to create a height map. The user can experiment with different views and degrees of detail by rotating the insert in 3D using a mouse, adjusting for more or less detail with the window/level sliders **602**, and by scaling with the vertical bar **604**. The Pulse button **606** animates the pixel heights in relation to the intensity change resulting from the pulse of pumping blood into the local vascular network. This creates a visual effect of pixels dancing in synchronization with the patient's heartbeat. The rise and fall height and rate of change in pixel intensity demonstrate the different responses of diseased and healthy tissue.

(33) The Grid Tool is shown in FIG. 7. Selecting the Grid tool brings up an overlay that draws grid lines to provide an x,y location reference **710**. The icon includes a “minus” and a “plus” touch point to grow or shrink the grid resolution **700**. Double clicking brings up a sub-menu **702** to select full or border grid lines and select line color and opacity. Default settings from the Personal Preferences are used when the tool is initialized.

(34) The grid is dynamically adjustable and the number of grid lines in x and y can be increased or decreased by user on the fly. The Grid Lines are selectable such that the user can select lines at borders **704**, across full image **708**, or none. Users can configure the attributes of the grid lines to set line weight, color and opacity **702**. In multi-display environments, the user can select which displays have grid lines. The user can configure the systems to display the coordinates of the visible cursor location **712**. This visual confirmation of cursor location can eliminate doubt and ease cognitive burden for the user. The system also offers the ability to save the personal settings for each user, including an option to recall “Last Used” settings.

(35) The Perfusion Visualization and Quantification tool is shown in FIG. 8. Selecting the Perfusion Visualization and Quantification tool brings up a panel that quantifies the degree and rate of selected tissue to absorb and dissipate contrast fluid (ICG) injected into a patient's blood stream **800**. The tool displays both endoscopic video channels (RGB **802** and IR **804**) and a third fused

image with the IR illuminated tissue transformed to fluorescent green for overlay on the RGB image **806**. The purpose is to assist the surgeon in characterizing the state of the tissue. Default settings from the Personal Preferences are used when the tool is initialized.

(36) The user sweeps an area of interest **806** to see a graph of the average pixel intensity (Y-axis) plotted against time (X-axis) **800**. The curve provides a quantitative measure of the tissue's absorption and decay rate for comparison with other areas to locate the healthiest tissue. Graphs respond in real time and may be moved about the image to explore responses. Graph results are plotted in different colors for comparison purposes **800**.

(37) The graph **800** provides an objective method to quantify the perfusion process using the degree of absorption and also the time to reach maximum intensity and the time to dissipate the agent. Without this tool, surgeons must rely on subjective measurements of color intensity and time.

(38) The tool enables a user to measuring rise time, the time it takes for a fluoresced pixel intensity to achieve maximum luminance, and the decay time, the time it take for a fluoresced pixel intensity to achieve initial state. The instant replay feature allows the user to view the fluorescing period at selective speeds to better observe the process. A graphical representation shows the amplitude and time of the fluorescing event in real time **800**. The tool is able to capture and compare multiple samples using software mechanisms to collect and compare multiple samples **806, 800**.

(39) The Color Collaboration tool, shown in FIG. **9**, presents the surgeon with a choice of views of the tissue surface with a choice of color maps **900**. The goal is to more clearly characterize the margins of diseased tissue, based on the individual color preference of a user.

(40) FIG. **9.1** is an example of different types of color processing for the Color Collaboration tool. In accordance with the preferred embodiment of the present invention, surgeons use color to identify and characterize tissue in many ways. However individual humans perceive color differently and surgery frequently involves a team of specialists, each perceiving color in their own way. Some form of color blindness effects ~8% of men and 0.5% of women and there are many types of color blindness—FIG. **9.1** illustrates three common forms of color blindness.

(41) By first sampling a surgeon's color perception against reference images **900**, the colors in the endoscopic video can be adjusted to present an image closer to a standard reference. Team members can have unique individual adjustments effected simultaneously by using dedicated displays, or special eyeglasses equipped with miniature color displays, or a primary display that can switch between color tables on command.

(42) Main Menu settings personalize the default choices for each surgeon. The defaults include the presentation format and color translation tables to display when the Color Map icon is selected **902**. Mouse clicking a selection brings it to the primary display window where it is subject to other tools for further analysis as shown in FIG. **9**.

(43) FIG. **10** is a block diagram illustrating the ICG Visualization module **1012** within the medical software tools platform. In accordance with the preferred embodiment of the present invention, an optical sensor **1002** located within an endoscopic camera lens **1000** registers the color characteristics reflected from a tissue surface. This image data **1004** is transmitted to the medical image processing system **1006**, which can also receive data from a device such as a patient heart rate monitor **1008**. The medical image processing system **1006** processes and transmits the image data **1004** from the optical sensor with data from the heart rate monitoring device **1008** to the user interface **1010**, whereby all sets of data are received through the optical signature measurement module **1012** displaying the rate of change **1014** in the color characteristics simultaneously with the patient vitals data **1016**. This data is analyzed **1018** in the module and the results of any anomaly detection **1020** are displayed to the user. The slight changes in one of more of the color components, and the speed at which they change, in relation to a source stimulus (heartbeat, breath, external stimulus) indicates the arrival of blood, contrast agents, or oxygen absorption. Combinations of the components can be used to characterize different types and states of disease

and to identify the margins of tumors and diseased areas.

(44) Although the disclosed technology is described above in terms of various exemplary embodiments and implementations, it should be understood that the various features, aspects and functionality described in one or more of the individual embodiments are not limited in their applicability to the particular embodiment with which they are described, but instead may be applied, alone or in various combinations, to one or more of the other embodiments of the disclosed technology, whether or not such embodiments are described and whether or not such features are presented as being a part of a described embodiment. Thus, the breadth and scope of the technology disclosed herein should not be limited by any of the above-described exemplary embodiments.

(45) Terms and phrases used in this document, and variations thereof, unless otherwise expressly stated, should be construed as open ended as opposed to limiting. As examples of the foregoing: the term “including” should be read as meaning “including, without limitation” or the like; the term “example” is used to provide exemplary instances of the item in discussion, not an exhaustive or limiting list thereof; the terms “a” or “an” should be read as meaning “at least one,” “one or more” or the like; and adjectives such as “conventional,” “traditional,” “normal,” “standard,” “known” and terms of similar meaning should not be construed as limiting the item described to a given time period or to an item available as of a given time, but instead should be read to encompass conventional, traditional, normal, or standard technologies that may be available or known now or at any time in the future. Likewise, where this document refers to technologies that would be apparent or known to one of ordinary skill in the art, such technologies encompass those apparent or known to the skilled artisan now or at any time in the future.

(46) The presence of broadening words and phrases such as “one or more,” “at least,” “but not limited to” or other like phrases in some instances shall not be read to mean that the narrower case is intended or required in instances where such broadening phrases may be absent. The use of the term “module” does not imply that the components or functionality described or claimed as part of the module are all configured in a common package. Indeed, any or all of the various components of a module, whether control logic or other components, may be combined in a single package or separately maintained and can further be distributed in multiple groupings or packages or across multiple locations.

(47) Additionally, the various embodiments set forth herein are described in terms of exemplary block diagrams, flow charts and other illustrations. As will become apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art after reading this document, the illustrated embodiments and their various alternatives may be implemented without confinement to the illustrated examples. For example, block diagrams and their accompanying description should not be construed as mandating a particular architecture or configuration.

(48) Embodiments presented are particular ways to realize the invention and are not inclusive of all ways possible. Therefore, there may exist embodiments that do not deviate from the spirit and scope of this disclosure as set forth by appended claims, but do not appear here as specific examples. It will be appreciated that a great plurality of alternative versions are possible.

Claims

1. A system for medical software tools, comprising: a first computer input device interface coupled with a first computer system, a second computer input device interface, configured to plurality of general computer input device interfaces, coupled to said first computer system, an image stream interface module configured to transmit an image stream from a surgical camera; a user interface overlay module configured to a first processor in said first computer system to provide a user interface overlay adapted for presentation over said image stream; an optical sensor corresponding with said surgical camera for registering momentary changes in spectral characteristics reflected

from a tissue surface under inspection; a medical software tools module configured to a surgeon's dashboard on said first computer system, capable of providing a plurality of medical software tools through said user interface module, and wherein said plurality of medical software tools are configured to perform an operation with respect to said image stream and provide an output adapted to be presented over said image stream; a medical image processing system configured to said first computer system for processing patient medical data and corresponding said patient medical data with said momentary changes in spectral characteristics; an optical signature, generated by way of said optical sensor, to present data indicative of various patient conditions, and wherein the medical software tool measures: a. changes in color intensity and b. rates at which said color intensities change in response to: heartbeat pushed blood, breathing pushed oxygen or light intensity or modulation from a light source; and a contrast fluorescent dye, associated with said tissue under inspection to provide an assessment of the perfusion of tissues and organs by identifying areas of highest absorption.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein said medical software tools module features an indocyanine green (ICG) visualization tool.

3. The system of claim 2, wherein said ICG visualization tool utilizes a camera sensor to capture and present color details unforeseen to the human eye.

4. The system of claim 1, further comprising of a color calibration tool for said medical software tools module.

5. The system of claim 1, wherein a display resolution of said image stream can be converted and scaled to add said user interface overlay.

6. The system of claim 1, wherein at least one of said plurality of medical software tools feature a grid tool to mark a location of an anomaly or area of interest during said operation.

7. The system of claim 1, wherein at least one of said plurality of medical software tools include a height mapping module and a perfusion, visualization, quantification and calibration module.

8. A method for medical software tools, comprising: configuring an image stream interface module to receive an image stream from a surgical camera; presenting a user interface overlay module to provide a user interface overlay over said image stream; registering momentary changes in spectral characteristics reflected from a tissue surface under inspection using an optical sensor corresponding with said surgical camera for: performing an operation with respect to the image stream and provide an output adapted to be presented over said image stream using a medical software tools module configured responsible for providing a plurality of medical software tools through said user interface; guiding, by way of at least one of said plurality of medical software tools, a medical professional through an operation using said image stream that is presented over said image stream; processing patient medical data with a medical image processing system, corresponding said patient medical data with said momentary changes in said spectral characteristics; generating optical signature data indicative of various patient conditions by way of said optical sensor; measuring, using at least one of said plurality of medical software tools, changes in color intensity of said tissue surface under inspection and a rate at which said color intensities change in response to: heartbeat pushed blood, breathing pushed oxygen or light intensity or modulation from a light source; and introducing a contrast fluorescent dye in associated with said tissue under inspection for an assessment of the perfusion of tissues and organs by an analysis of areas of absorption.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein said medical software tools module features an indocyanine green (ICG) visualization tool.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein said ICG visualization tool utilizes a camera sensor to capture and present color details unforeseen to the human eye.

11. The system of claim 8, further comprising of a color calibration tool for said medical software tools module.

12. The system of claim 8, wherein a display resolution of said image stream can be converted and

scaled to add said user interface overlay.

13. The system of claim 8, wherein at least one of said plurality of medical software tools feature a grid tool to mark a location of an anomaly or area of interest during said operation.
 14. The system of claim 1, wherein at least one of said plurality of medical software tools include a height mapping module and a perfusion, visualization, quantification and calibration module.
 15. A system for medical software tools, comprising: a first computer input device interface coupled with a first computer system; a second computer input device interface configured to plurality of general computer input device interfaces coupled to said first computer system; an image stream interface module configured to transmit an image stream from a surgical camera; a user interface overlay module configured to a first processor in said first computer system to provide a user interface overlay adapted for presentation over said image stream, and wherein said user interface overlay module enables a user to convert, scale and modify the resolution of said image stream presented in said image stream interface module; wherein said user interface overlay module enables a medical professional to mark an area of interest throughout an operation; an optical sensor corresponding with said surgical camera for registering momentary changes in spectral characteristics reflected from a tissue surface under inspection; a medical software tools module configured to a surgeon's dashboard on said first computer system, capable of providing a plurality of medical software tools through said user interface module, and wherein said plurality of medical software tools are configured to perform an operation with respect to said image stream and provide an output adapted to be presented over said image stream; a medical image processing system configured to said first computer system for processing patient medical data and corresponding said patient medical data with said momentary changes in spectral characteristics; an optical signature, generated by way of said optical sensor, to present data indicative of various patient conditions, and wherein the medical software tool measures: a. changes in color intensity through a color calibration tool and b. rates at which said color intensities change in response to: heartbeat pushed blood, breathing pushed oxygen or light intensity or modulation from a light source; and an indocyanine green visualization tool, configured to a camera sensor for visualizing a contrast fluorescent dye in association with said tissue under inspection to provide an assessment of the perfusion of tissues and organs by identifying areas of highest absorption.
 16. The system of claim 15, further comprising of said indocyanine green visualization tool using color calibration to determine indocyanine green absorption levels of said area of interest.
 17. The system of claim 15, wherein an indocyanine green visualization user interface for said indocyanine green visualization tool is used in conjunction with said user interface overlay module to modify a frame rate and height map of said image stream.
 18. The system of claim 15, further comprising of said indocyanine green visualization tool simulating a 3D rendition of an area of high perfusion and absorption of indocyanine green and generate an intensity and speed map of said area of interest.
 19. The system of claim 15, wherein an area selected by a mouse can render a compact image of said area of interest while viewing said image stream and simulate a 3D view by mapping said area of interest's pixels on an elevation grid.
 20. The system of claim 19, wherein said mouse is used to adjust and modify a view of said compact image by using a plurality of window and level sliders.
-